



Plants for exposed sites

Select resilient plants for gardens where temperatures dip well below freezing in winter or are buffeted by strong winds or coastal spray.

Trees and shrubs from mountainous regions are ideal for frosty and exposed sites, their names often giving clues to their antecedents—*Alchemilla alpina* and *Geranium himalayense*, for example. Many hardy perennials avoid the worst of the winter weather by disappearing beneath the surface and lying dormant until spring, while hardy evergreens fight the cold with an antifreeze solution of sugars and amino acids within their cells. Choose a selection of plants, such as snowdrops, that flower in winter to brighten up this bleak time of the year, and use evergreens for permanent structure and color.



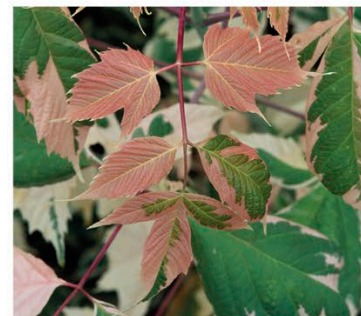
TREE LARGE

Abies concolor

WHITE FIR This evergreen conifer tree is grown for its silver foliage and Christmas-tree shape. Plant it as a lawn specimen or part of a mixed, windbreak screen in large yards. Pruning may spoil the shape.

↑100ft (30m) ↔25ft (8m)

☀ Z3–7 N



TREE LARGE

Acer negundo

BOXELDER This tree has a rounded head and reddish brown lobed leaves that turn midgreen in summer and have striking fall color. 'Flamingo' (above) has white and pink variegated leaves. Pollard to keep it compact.

↑50ft (15m) ↔30ft (10m)

☀ Z3–8



TREE LARGE

Acer saccharinum

SILVER MAPLE A large, lobed, round-headed tree, with dark green foliage that develops a fiery color in fall, particularly in colder regions. Use it as a specimen; plant in a sheltered site to avoid wind damage: it is prone to breakage in heavy storms.

↑70ft (20m) ↔40ft (12m)

☀ Z3–9 N



PERENNIAL SMALL

Alchemilla alpina

ALPINE LADY'S MANTLE This mat-forming perennial has rounded, dark green divided leaves with a silver hairy reverse and frothy greenish yellow summer flowers. Hardy and wind-resistant, plant it in a rock garden or wild corner. Avoid hot dry areas.

↑6in (15cm) ↔24in (60cm) or more

☀ Z3–7



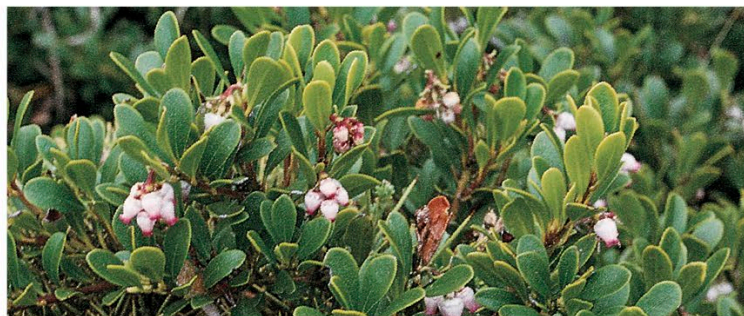
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aquilegia vulgaris

COLUMBINE A ferny green-leaved perennial with wiry upright stems of bell-shaped blue, pink, purple, or white flowers in late spring and early summer. Grow in informal and cottage borders in cold sites; weed out unwanted seedlings.

↑24in (60cm) ↔20in (50cm)

☀ Z3–8



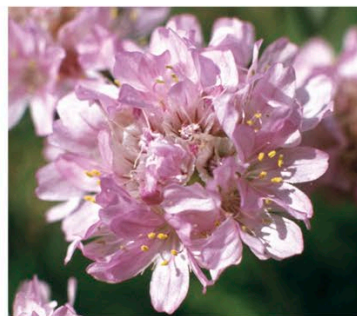
SHRUB SMALL

Arctostaphylos uva-ursi

BEARBERRY A creeping evergreen shrub with glossy, oval green leaves, silver below. The small, pink or white urn-shaped blooms appear from spring to early summer, followed by red berries. Cascade this mountain plant over walls or rock gardens.

↑4in (10cm) ↔20in (50cm)

☀ 卐 Z2–6 N



PERENNIAL SMALL

Armeria maritima

THRIFT A hummock-forming evergreen with grasslike leaves and stiff stems bearing pompom-shaped pink flowers from late spring to summer. This hardy plant is salt- and wind-tolerant, ideal for alpine troughs, rock gardens, and raised beds.

↑4in (10cm) ↔6in (15cm)

☀ Z4–8 N



PERENNIAL SMALL

Aster alpinus

ALPINE ASTER A clump-forming perennial with midgreen, narrow lance-shaped leaves. It bears large, daisy-like violet-blue late summer blooms with a yellow central disk. Plant this wind-proof alpine on banks and in gravel gardens and raised beds.

↑6in (15cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ Z4–8